José David Serna

Game Developer | Unity & C# | UX/UI Design

Medellín, Colombia | Remote (UTC-5) | jdserna00@gmail.com |
jdserna00.github.io/JDSerna00 | github.com/jdserna00 | linkedin.com/in/josé-serna-88034334a

Professional Summary

Game developer with a UX design focus and 2+ years building mobile, tower-defense and educational games in Unity and C#. Led mid-development and post-launch work on a live mobile idle game, cutting Firebase latency by 70% and raising daily retention through A/B-tested UI flows. Comfortable owning the full loop: gameplay programming, art production in Blender and pixel art, and research-driven UI design.

Skills

- **Engine & Programming:** Unity (2D & 3D), C#, Lua, Python, SQL
- **Gameplay Systems:** Gameplay programming, pathfinding, targeting and enemy AI, game design, game architecture, performance optimization and profiling
- **Backend & Tools:** Firebase, Git & GitHub, Jira, Trello, Figma
- **Art & UX/UI:** Blender (3D), pixel art, UX research, UI implementation, design systems, A/B testing, retention analysis
- **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (professional working proficiency)

Professional Experience

Mid-Development & Post-Launch Lead | Root Connections (idle mobile game) | Remote | Aug 2025 – Jul 2026

- Reduced Firebase latency by 70% by restructuring client calls into batched requests, improving load performance for the live player base.
- Increased daily retention by designing and running A/B-tested UI flows, iterating on onboarding and progression screens based on measured results.
- Owned the post-launch roadmap end to end: performance profiling, UX research, and feature implementation in Unity/C#.

- Partnered with design to prioritize fixes by player impact and ship on a live release cadence.

Lead Developer & UX/UI Designer | Mangrove Rescue (educational game) | Remote/Hybrid | Jul 2025 – Nov 2025

- Led core mechanics and art implementation for an educational game aimed at young players.
- Designed accessible, intuitive UX and UI for younger players, simplifying onboarding and reducing confusion.
- Coordinated a cross-functional team of 9 in Jira, translating learning objectives into playable systems.

Freelance Developer | Commissioned Projects | Remote | Feb 2025 – Jun 2025

- Worked directly in English with international clients to gather requirements, report progress, and deliver milestones on schedule.
- Turned non-technical client feedback into concrete technical and usability changes.
- Ran end-to-end QA and live troubleshooting during handoffs, minimizing post-delivery defects.

Solo Developer & Artist | FrelseTD (pixel art tower defense) | Feb 2024 – May 2024

- Programmed all tower and enemy behavior in Unity/C#, including pathfinding and targeting logic.
- Produced the complete pixel art asset set and implemented every in-game interface.
- Delivered the project solo from concept to playable build, managing scope across art, code, and UI.

Self-Directed | Side Projects | Ongoing

- Building a Postknight-inspired RPG prototype with a database backend to strengthen SQL and data-driven game systems.

Education

Bachelor of Engineering in Digital Entertainment Design | Universidad Pontificia Bolivariana | Medellín, Colombia | Expected 2027

Relevant coursework: User Experience (UX) Research, Human-Computer Interaction, Database Management (SQL), Project Management, Agile Workflows